

Marufa Akter: "It's me vs me, not me vs others"

At 20, Marufa Akter is turning heads with her speed and swing. Here's how Bangladesh's **pace prodigy** came to be.

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In the months leading up to the Women's ODI World Cup, co-hosted by India and Sri Lanka, Bangladesh pacer Marufa Akter could think of little else but her debut on the grand stage.

"I always thinking, when I'm sleeping, always I'm thinking, first match, I do better. Always, I am the match winner (sic)," she said after helping her side to a cherished win against Pakistan in the campaign opener in Colombo.

The joy of a job well done was written all over her face. The only pacer selected in a lineup packed with spinners — built to suit the



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